

MOTOR TRAFFIC ACT OF SRI LANKA
COMPLETE LEGAL FRAMEWORK FOR VEHICLE REGISTRATION & MANAGEMENT

PART I: REGISTRATION, POSSESSION AND USE OF MOTOR VEHICLES

Section 2: Motor vehicles not to be possessed or used without registration

- No person shall possess or use a motor vehicle unless registered
- Dealers/manufacturers may possess unregistered vehicles for sale under specific licenses
- Penalties: First offense: Rs. 2,500-5,000; Second: Rs. 5,000-10,000; Third: Rs. 10,000-15,000

Section 3: Motor vehicles not to be registered unless they comply with requirements

- Vehicle must conform to construction, weight, dimensions, and equipment standards
- Commissioner-General shall not register vehicles if:
 - Manufactured/assembled illegally or without approval
 - Assembled without branded new parts
 - Mechanically defective or fails safety standards
 - Stolen or has false identity
 - Chassis number tampered with
 - Application contains forged documents

Section 7: Application for registration

- Must be made in prescribed form
- Signed by person entitled to possession
- Must include all required particulars
- Weight proof required for vehicles other than motorcycles

Section 9: Distinctive number and certificate of registration

- Commissioner-General assigns distinctive number
- Registers applicant as owner
- Issues certificate of registration
- Special provisions for multiple ownership claims
- Hire-purchase agreements require absolute owner entry

PART II: CONSTRUCTION AND EQUIPMENT

Section 19A: Manufacturing and assembly requirements

- Prior written approval required for any manufacturing/assembly
- Commissioner-General may refuse approval if terms not met
- Penalties: Rs. 50,000-100,000 plus vehicle confiscation

PART III: REVENUE LICENSES AND TRANSFERS

Section 11A: Transfer procedures

- Must use prescribed Forms A, A1, B, B1, C, C1
- Transfer must be completed within 14 days
- Penalties for late registration: Rs. 100/day up to 44 days, then Rs. 5,000-10,000

Section 12: Change of possession procedures

- Registered owner must inform Commissioner-General within 14 days
- New owner must apply for registration within 14 days
- Police may detain vehicle for ownership verification

PENALTIES AND OFFENSES:

- Using unregistered vehicle: Rs. 2,500-15,000 (escalating)
- Forged documents: Rs. 10,000-15,000
- Unlawful manufacturing: Rs. 50,000-300,000 plus imprisonment
- Late transfer notification: Rs. 3,000-6,000